

A bad senior hire doesn't just cost a salary.

It costs months of runway, team momentum, and trust. It usually happens the same way: an interview process that's inconsistent, under-documented, and leans on gut feel more than evidence. By the time it's clear something's wrong, it's already expensive to fix.

The numbers back this up. In the UK, the Recruitment & Employment Confederation and Oxford Economics put the real cost of a bad hire at **three to four times their salary**, once training and lost productivity are counted. SHRM's research puts it at **50–200%**, and even the more conservative US Department of Labor estimate starts at **30%**.

WHAT I DO

I run the interview process. I don't source candidates.

I'm not a recruiter, and I don't work on volume. I design the interview loop, run the interviews myself, and hand you a hire or no-hire recommendation you can trust.

HOW IT WORKS

Four stages, agreed before a single interview happens.

01 Kickoff

A working session with you and your team to define exactly what "great" looks like for this role, not a generic job spec, the real bar.

02 Loop design

A structured interview plan, mapped to the competencies that actually matter for this hire, agreed with you before a single interview happens.

03 Structured interviews

Every stage scored against a consistent rubric, with evidence captured in the room rather than reconstructed from memory afterward.

04 Evidence-based report

A clear recommendation, with the reasoning laid out competency by competency, including the risks if you hire and my honest confidence level.

HOW I WORK

The standard every engagement is held to.

Mutual trust. You're handing me one of the most consequential decisions your team will make this quarter. In return, I need everything relevant, including the context, the constraints, and the history of what's gone wrong before.

Honest feedback, every time. My read on every candidate is unbiased and backed by evidence. If someone isn't right for the role, you'll hear that clearly, since I don't soften a call to make a process feel smoother.

AI is a tool, not a replacement. I use it to take notes and help write reports clearly. I never ask it for an opinion. Every assessment, every score, every recommendation is mine.

Fees are bespoke. I don't price by interview count or seniority as a blunt formula. We scope the effort together, then price it, because what you're paying for is the outcome, not a set of meetings.

We do this together. What "great" looks like for a role isn't something I decide alone from a spec. It comes from the people who'll manage this person, sit next to them, and depend on them.

I am your team. I will never recommend a hire I don't believe is right. If I wouldn't hire this person myself, I won't tell you to.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Engineering leaders hiring senior or high-stakes roles who want a rigorous, structured process without building and running it themselves, and who'd rather hear an honest no than a convenient yes.

Every engagement is scoped and priced together, before we start.

Bespoke, per hire